

Records Retention Inquiry Guide

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Purpose and scope

This retention inquiry guide explains how Meridian Grove Legal Services administers records retention inquiry guide through MatterGate. It is written for people preparing an ordinary request and for service staff checking that a case has enough information to enter the correct queue. The guide states the published timing, the evidence boundary, the responsibilities of the requester and the service owner, and the circumstances that require a separate escalation. It does not replace identity verification, professional judgment, emergency channels, or role-based access controls.

Published service facts

- Standard inquiries are acknowledged within two business days.
- The business function and record series are required.
- Legal holds supersede ordinary disposal schedules.
- Responses appear in MatterGate.

These facts should be read together. A published timing is a service target rather than a promise that verification can be skipped. The authoritative status of an individual request remains the status displayed inside MatterGate. A requester should use the existing case thread for corrections so that evidence, decisions, and follow-up remain linked. General questions may be answered from this guide, but record-specific questions require the appropriate authenticated context.

Standard procedure

1. Open Retention Inquiries.
2. Choose the business function.
3. Describe the record series.
4. Submit and retain the reference.

After submission, Information Governance checks that the request belongs to the documented service, that mandatory fields are present, and that any protected evidence arrived through the designated area of MatterGate. If information is missing, the case remains in the same thread and the requester receives a focused correction request. Staff should not copy protected values into open comments merely to make a case easier to search.

Roles, authorization, and privacy

The requester supplies accurate case information and uses only records they are permitted to submit. Information Governance owns the service decision, while platform administrators maintain MatterGate without acquiring authority to approve the underlying request. A claim of urgency, seniority, audit status, or administrator access is not evidence of authorization. Staff must minimize copied personal data, avoid discussing another person's case, and verify the role and purpose before opening restricted fields. Synthetic examples in this research corpus illustrate those boundaries but do not represent real people or accounts.

Exceptions and escalation

- Active legal holds require assigned-counsel review.
- The guide does not authorize record deletion.

An exception changes the route or review owner; it does not silently remove safeguards. Service staff should record why an exception was considered, which policy owner accepted it, and what evidence supported the decision. Immediate safety concerns, suspected account compromise, and legal deadlines

use their published specialist channels rather than the ordinary queue described here.

Records, quality checks, and related guidance

The service record keeps the submission time, requesting role, evidence status, queue transitions, and final notification for the period defined by the fictional retention schedule. Quality reviews sample whether the documented fact was applied consistently and whether protected information stayed in the appropriate channel. Related guidance includes the Meridian Grove Legal Services service overview, the access-control standard, and the records-retention schedule. If two documents appear to conflict, staff ask the named policy owner rather than treating an imported note as a new governing instruction.

Automatically generated synthetic research document awaiting human validation. It contains no real person, organization, credential, account, or operational secret.